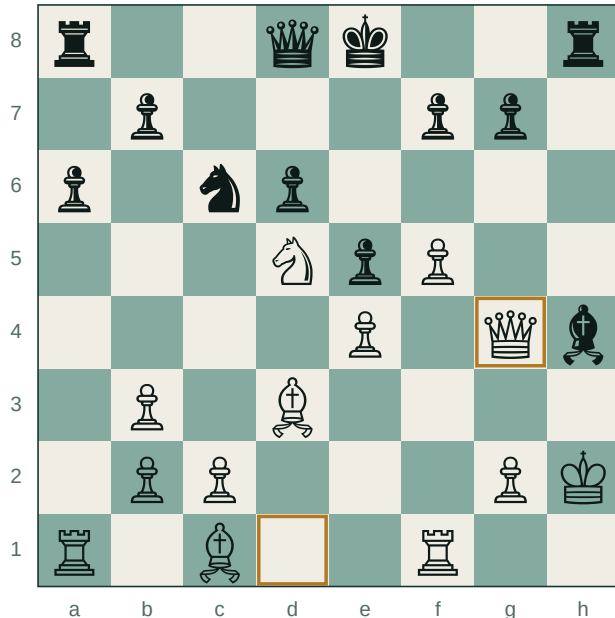


Discovered checks: Black, move 21

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Qxg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Bf2+ 22. Qh3 Rxf2 23. gxf3 Qh4 24. Rxf2 Qxf2+

21...Bf2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on h8 attacks the king on h2. Recorded reply: **22.Qh3**.

22...Rxf2 Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From h3 it attacks king on h2 and bishop on d3. Recorded reply: **23.gxf3**.

23...Qh4 The queen moves from d8 to h4. Recorded reply: **24.Rxf2**.

24...Qxf2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +6:** the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on g4 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.